

6.87m subscribers added

The Cellular Operators Association of India says 6.87 million new GSM subscribers were added in March, making it 664.08 million total <http://dgit.in/Jjnp7W>



Pics in space

12 incredible photographs taken from Earth's orbit <http://dgit.in/JIEGLR>



ASUS VS247H

Equalizer mode worked quite well in darker regions of the game. Movie viewing was a pleasure on all the competing monitors, but we did experience some amount of backlight bleeding on the Dell U2412M.

27-INCHES

We were frankly surprised out of our wits, when we saw so many 27-inch monitors. As mentioned earlier, last year in the comparison test we had only one 27-incher. All the monitors in this segment support the 16:9 aspect ratio and have a native resolution of 1920x1080 pixels. Philips 273P3LPH sports a TN panel and looks the sturdiest among the lot. It has special infrared sensors, which detect the presence of a user. If you are away from your desk, it automatically reduces brightness to save power, and if you are away for a longer duration, it switches off the backlight completely. There are touch sensitive buttons on the monitor which are a pain to use. The OSD is well laid out and there are lots of tweaking options, but if you have to constantly tap on the touch buttons to activate certain menus, it just becomes a point-less exercise after a while.

AOC e2795Vh along with BenQ GL2750HM are the

most basic looking 27-inch monitors offering only tilt mechanism. Both these monitors are priced very aggressively, in fact they are cheaper than some 24-inch monitors. The AOC e2795Vh has a range of connectivity options. Its OSD layout is quite good and thanks to the but-

tons present just below the monitor bezel, navigating and tweaking is pain-free. The GL2750HM offers the basic feature sets seen in other GL series of monitors, which is aimed at entertainment use.

The BenQ EW2730 is the only VA panel based monitor in this segment and has aes-

thetics which are very similar to the EW2430, which includes a brush metal finish on the base stand, glossy black plastic finish on the rear of the monitor, tactile buttons located behind the monitor to navigate the OSD menu, among others. There are stereo speakers facing down and it has the similar number of display ports such as two HDMI ports and single DVI and D Sub ports. It also bundles in a remote control, thus making OSD operations possible from your couch.

ASUS VK278Q is a full HD display and the only one to feature a 2.0 MP camera atop the monitor. It has a glossy black body – a finger-print and dust magnet. The screen has a matte finish. The OSD buttons are located at the base of the bezel on the right hand side. It has all four display ports, alongwith in-built speakers. You only get

the tilt option. We were quite impressed with the Picture-in-Picture option which allows you to get feeds from two display sources.

The other ASUS 27-inch monitor was the 3D supporting VG278H. The webcam unit on the VK278Q is replaced by 3D emitter for 3D glasses. The ability to tilt the emitter is quite functional as it allows you to get the best reception without having to tilt the monitor. It also supports the NVIDIA Light-boost technology offered by the 3D Vision 2 kit. You have quite a lot of preset options to select from including an sRGB mode and picture adjustment options include skin tone adjustment, smartview among others. It offers tilt as well as height adjustment options.

When it came to performance, the VA panel based BenQ

3D GAMING EXPERIENCE

Since we had around three 3D gaming monitors, we decided to try out a couple of games on them, to see how good the experience was. Now 3D gaming is a very subjective thing, hence we did not use it for scoring. The two games we tested were *Dirt 3* and *Crysis: Warhead*. While the *Dirt 3* has an Excellent rating in the list of compatibility with NVIDIA 3D Vision control panel, *Crysis Warhead* has a Good rating.

While playing *Dirt 3* with the regular camera mode, where you see the complete car, you will not encounter much depth. But enter the driver-seat camera mode, and you see proper layers of depths. With the ASUS VS278H's on-board emitter, the setup of the 3D vision glasses wasn't much of a hassle, but whenever the car banged into any obstacle, the screen would freeze momentarily

and give artifacts before quickly moving on with the game. With the dedicated 3D emitter we did not notice this issue. On the BenQ XL2420T we had a smooth experience. On both these monitors, the 3D depth should be around 20 percent, anything more and you will witness a lot of crosstalk. The Acer monitor requires HDMI 1.4a cables, which is bundled with the monitor. We found it quite strange that it did not have a DVI-D port.

Crysis Warhead on any 3D monitor, will give you a headache. Thanks to forest scene which involves abundant trees, it becomes very difficult to notice any depth. We also experienced a lot of stuttering, wherein the 3D view would disappear and you would see crosstalk images before the control was restored to 3D view. Getting a clean headshot

is out of the question as the reticular circle which forms the target is not very steady. Overall, none of the monitors gave a decent experience with *Crysis Warhead*. This was just our experience. Some of you may find the 3D gaming experience to be very good and others won't last 5 minutes with those clunky glasses. It is best to stick to games that have an Excellent rating on the NVIDIA 3D control panel.

Among the 3D monitors, the choice was quite obvious as the costing of the ASUS VS278H is very restrictive. The BenQ XL2420T gave an experience that was quite similar to the the ASUS monitor, while being priced at 40 percent the cost of the ASUS monitor. Plus the amount of tweaking options offered on XL2420T were much better than the VS 278H.